

What good is our gathering if the city receives no light from us?

But we have worked hard. We have exposed those who tried to deceive us.

And the Lord commends that. Now He is asking us to remember the love from which those works first came.

When we first heard of Him, knowing Him became more precious than everything we had been pursuing.

That is how Paul described it. Everything he once counted as gain became loss beside the surpassing value of knowing Christ.

How does that become light for the city?

As His life takes shape in ours. His wisdom guides our decisions.

His truth makes us trustworthy. His love teaches us to care for people who have nothing to offer us.

Then we must examine more than the teaching of those who visit us.

We must examine what people encounter when they come among us.

EPHESUS
THOSE WHO SAY THEY ARE APOSTLES

They came to us saying they had been sent by Christ.

I thought that meant we could trust what they taught.

An apostle is one who is sent. We still had to examine whether their claim was true.

The Lord has sent me. If you question me, you question Him.

Then help us understand what you are teaching.

He never answered you.

He asked whether I accepted his authority.

Paul warned the Corinthians about deceitful workers presenting themselves as apostles of Christ.

So we examined the message. It did not agree with what we had received about Christ.

I had begun defending him before I had examined what he was saying.